Chapter 2

Handle Failures by Planning Ahead

When a user is on your website or app and something goes wrong—even if it's not something you expected to fail—the user will often retry what they were doing. If the underlying problem was transient, say their internet connection momentarily dropped, the retry will succeed and all is well (outside of a minor annoyance).

Your Sidekiq jobs don't have a patient user hanging around willing to retry when things go wrong. Even if they did, there's no guarantee that retrying the jobs will fix any underlying causes for failure (of which there are many). Nevertheless, your code needs to run to completion and you have to have some strategy to deal with failures. That's what you'll learn about here.

You'll learn how to monitor the failures of our jobs, how to allow transient failures to automatically retry without over-notifying you, and how to make sure that every job eventually succeeds. But first, it's good to know why this matters at all.